Jose Alberto Tupayachi Silva

Ph.D. Candidate, Industrial Engineering · **AI & Data Researcher**

661-365-5289 | jtupayac@vols.utk.edu | tupayachisja@ornl.gov

linkedin.com/in/jose-tupayachi-582339147 | github.com/jtupayachi | jtupayachi.github.io

SUMMARY

Industrial Engineering Ph.D. candidate at the University of Tennessee, Knoxville and researcher at Oak Ridge National Laboratory who builds AI, optimization and simulation systems for transportation, health and materials science. Teaching assistant for courses in simulation, reliability engineering and engineering management, guest lecturer on digital twins, and workshop leader on Git and research collaboration tools. Mentors students and connects engineering theory to hands-on practice, drawing on prior industry experience in data engineering and analytics. Publishes in peer-reviewed journals and conferences, with a Best Paper Award and an IISE Future Faculty Fellowship.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Operations & Business Analytics: Excel (pivot tables, Power Query, lookups, financial models), SQL, Power BI, Tableau, Looker Studio, standardized and ad hoc reporting, KPI and operational dashboards, forecasting (demand, capacity, equipment), financial and productivity modeling, data-gathering and reporting procedures, Cycle Time to Action (CTA) reduction

Industrial Engineering & Operations Research: Linear, integer, network-flow and stochastic programming (Gurobi, CPLEX), discrete-event simulation (AnyLogic), reliability engineering (Weibull, FMEA, remaining-useful-life prognostics), condition monitoring and fault detection, supply chain and intermodal logistics, network analysis (NetworkX), engineering economic analysis, KPI design, usability testing, Agile/Scrum, requirements gathering with business stakeholders

AI & Machine Learning: Machine learning engineering, deep learning, LLMs, RAG, agentic AI workflows, CNNs, 1D-CNN, Vision Transformers (ViT, Swin), Graph Neural Networks, TensorFlow, PyTorch, statistical and predictive modeling, clustering, regression, tree-based and boosting models (Random Forest, LightGBM, XGBoost), model tuning and calibration, explainable AI

LLM & Agentic Frameworks: LangChain, LangGraph, LiteLLM, vLLM, Ollama, llama.cpp, QLoRA fine-tuning, BERT and sentence transformers, vector databases, knowledge graphs (Neo4j), ontology-guided reasoning

Data Engineering: Apache Spark (Scala/PySpark), Hadoop/MapReduce, Hive, Kafka, ETL/ELT, batch and real-time streaming, Delta Lake, Databricks Workflows, Unity Catalog, dbt, Airflow, Prefect, data modeling, entity resolution, data quality, anomaly detection, Snowflake, Amazon Redshift, dimensional modeling, performance optimization

Cloud & Infrastructure: AWS (S3, EMR, Redshift, SageMaker, ECS), Microsoft Azure, Google Cloud (BigQuery), Docker, Kubernetes, UNIX/Linux, KVM, Slurm and GNU Parallel (HPC), CI/CD, Jenkins, Git, GitLab

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, SQL Server, MongoDB, Cassandra, Neo4j

Languages: Python, SQL, Scala, Java, R, SAS, STATA, SPSS, Bash, Dart, PHP, C++, CUDA

Web, Mobile & APIs: Django, Flask, Streamlit, Dash, React, Flutter, Laravel, GetX, REST and GraphQL APIs, Power BI, Tableau, Looker Studio

Geospatial & Networks: NetworkX, WMS, GeoServer, OverPass API, Turf.js

Certifications: Microsoft Fabric DP-600 and DP-700, MS Transact-SQL (T-SQL), AWS, Google Cloud

EXPERIENCE

Developer · Oak Ridge National Laboratory — Mar 2025 – Present

Oak Ridge, TN · DOE Fusion Energy Sciences, EM and NSRD programs

- Built a multi-pathway **Vision Transformer** agentic pipeline that classifies microstructure, defects and phases across **1,000+ SEM images**, replacing days-per-batch expert annotation with reproducible classification and auto-generated structured reports.
- Deployed a **LangChain/LangGraph RAG** workflow (Qwen and Llama on Ollama, vector DB) that ingests and cross-references **200+ technical papers**, cutting expert review **to under 1 hour** per batch with full source traceability.
- Fine-tuned a **Swin Transformer** that quality-screens wind speed and direction from distributed weather stations before they feed atmospheric plume models, and built explainable ML (DL, 1D-CNN) for extreme-weather prediction.
- Built a natural-language geospatial dashboard generator with knowledge-graph reasoning and agent self-validation (llama.cpp, LangChain, vLLM), so non-experts build analyses without engineering help; **filed as an ORNL IP disclosure (2026)** and shipped as a public Docker image.
- Deployed a GPU-accelerated (cuML) spectral and spatial analysis pipeline that processes raw IONTOF ToF-SIMS instrument files (.itax/.itmx) end to end.

Graduate Research Assistant · University of Tennessee, Knoxville — Aug 2022 – Present

Knoxville, TN · Advisors: Dr. Xueping Li (UTK) and Dr. Xiao-Ying Yu (ORNL)

- Served as **Lead AI/Data Engineer** on the **$3M DOE ARPA-E RECOIL** freight digital twin: owned the AI/data workstream across **100+ intermodal nodes**, automating route optimization, demand forecasting and what-if analysis behind a production LLM chatbot that cut stakeholders' Cycle Time to Action from **hours to minutes**.
- Parallelized and scheduled experiment runs on HPC (**Slurm, GNU Parallel**) and **mentored junior students** in model development and Git workflows to cut run times; led a Git workshop for a research-methods class.

- Shipped Flutter mobile health apps for **Android, iOS, watchOS and Wear OS** (SmartShots, Active Caregiver's Toolkit) published on the App Store and Google Play; SmartShots won the IISE DAIS Student Mobile App Competition.
- Developed **decentralized (federated) prognostics** for industrial equipment, detecting faults and estimating remaining useful life across distributed assets with heterogeneous sensor data, without centralizing raw data (*Computers & Electrical Engineering*, 2026).
- Tracked, analyzed and forecast freight flows, network capacity and EV charging equipment demand across **100+ intermodal nodes** and **86 charging stations** to plan capacity and equipment requirements.
- Built an ontology-guided intermodal routing optimizer (linear optimization) and a Traffic-Weather GCN for EV charging-demand forecasting (**MAE 0.064**, more than **10x** lower than classical baselines).

Data Engineer · Indra Mar 2022 – Aug 2022

- Led the migration of **3 core tables of about 5,000 variables each (about 18M customers)** from a legacy Oracle warehouse to a partitioned AWS lakehouse (S3, EMR, Hive) with **zero data loss**, redesigning schemas into dimensional star models and re-implementing Oracle stored-procedure logic in PySpark/Scala.
- Tuned Spark executor memory and cores per job, broadcast-join thresholds, partition pruning and file coalescing, removing OOM shuffle spills and small-file problems that slowed downstream queries.
- Automated entity resolution and deduplication across the 18M-record client base, and built scheduled ETL/ELT pipelines in Python, Scala and Shell on UNIX/Linux in Agile cycles.
- Automated CI/CD with Jenkins (builds, unit tests, live deployment, rollback, backups) to cut manual effort and deployment risk.
- Used knowledge of the business and data structures to anticipate data problems, building an automated data-quality engine (profiling, validation rules, drift detection, monitoring and alerting) that catches issues before downstream reporting.

Business Intelligence Analyst · Globokas Jan 2022 – Mar 2022

- Automated KPI reporting by integrating **10+ heterogeneous sources** (transactional databases, collections, billing, payment-center feeds) into unified BigQuery, Looker Studio and Power BI pipelines that feed self-refreshing executive KPI dashboards for multiple business clients.
- Developed **standardized and ad hoc client reporting**, and designed the data-gathering and reporting procedures used by operations teams.

Data Analyst · Enel Distribución Nov 2020 – Dec 2021

- Segmented **1.6M utility customers** with K-Means and hierarchical clustering on payment history and demographics, lifting collection-campaign hit rate by **about 15%** and lowering cost per recovered account.
- **Automated invoice verification** and special-case processing with a PyQt desktop app, removing manual verification steps from the billing workflow.
- Provided **ongoing analysis of operational activities** (collections, billing, payments) with Excel, SQL/T-SQL, Power BI and Tableau, using visual dashboards to surface timely insights for operations teams.
- **Partnered with Finance** to build Excel-based cost and productivity models for collection operations, supporting budget and staffing decisions.
- Coordinated with the Operations Systems and IT teams to identify, escalate and resolve data and system issues across SQL Server databases and API-based Salesforce integrations.

Developer, Portfolio Valuation · GPS Management Aug 2020 – Nov 2020

- **Automated the loan-scoring workflow** with machine learning and financial models for non-performing loan (NPL) recovery and portfolio valuation, reducing manual processing time (presented at POMS Lima, 2022).

IT Intern · Quiron Salud Jan 2019 – Aug 2019

- Maintained healthcare plan information systems and supported electronic health record integration and database administration for clinical operations.
- Coordinated with clinical operations and the IT systems group so technical issues were identified, addressed and resolved in a timely manner.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant, Industrial & Systems Engineering · University of Tennessee, Knoxville Fall 2022 – Fall 2026
IE 406/408 Simulation · IE 483 Reliability Engineering · IE 533 Engineering Management

- **IE 406/408 Simulation (Fall 2022):** held TA office hours on AnyLogic simulation modeling and led a hands-on lab for **about 25 students** linking discrete-event simulation to deep reinforcement learning (wildfire-suppression MDP benchmarked against nearest-unit and priority-queue heuristics), based on my ANNSIM 2024 paper.
- **IE 483 Reliability Engineering (Spring 2023):** contributed to exam and homework preparation and ran a Weibull and FMEA workshop (maximum-likelihood fits, remaining-useful-life estimates, Risk Priority Numbers) on real industrial sensor failure data.
- **IE 533 Theory and Practice of Engineering Management (Fall 2026, current):** give written feedback on student assignments and assist with grading.

Guest Lecture and Workshop · UCF · University of Tennessee, Knoxville

- **Guest lecture on digital twins** at the University of Central Florida with Prof. Soheil Sabri, using intermodal freight case studies from RECOIL.
- **Git workshop** for a UTK research-methods class, teaching version control and collaboration tools through day-to-day research examples.

PROJECTS

RECOIL · Cognitive Freight Transportation Digital Twin Jul 2024 – Mar 2026
Lead AI/Data Engineer · DOE ARPA-E, $3M (DE-AR0001780) · m1.recoil.ise.utk.edu

- Modeled a national U.S. freight network of **100+ intermodal nodes** (road, rail, waterway, EV charging); the ontology-guided GIS optimizer projects a **15–20% cut in per-route CO_2** versus truck-only baselines (arXiv:2410.18089).
- Built and published the Traffic-Weather GCN on proprietary ChargePoint data (**86 stations, 13 months**): **MAE 0.064, RMSE 0.573**, against SVM 0.649, XGBoost 0.941, Random Forest 0.936, LightGBM 0.948 and Linear Regression 1.022 MAE (arXiv:2510.09048).
- Deployed a trade-off analysis chatbot (Neo4j knowledge graph, vector embeddings, BERT/sentence-transformer literature index) used by **20+ domain experts and DOE stakeholders**, shortening decision turnaround from **hours to minutes** for non-technical users.
- Automated a real-time streaming feedback loop that continuously re-optimizes routing under weather, traffic and demand changes, reducing unnecessary truck miles versus static batch baselines.

Automated Geospatial Analysis Interface · ORNL, NSRD Mar 2025 – Present
github.com/jtupayachi/smartgiscavp · ORNL IP disclosure (2026)

- End-to-end LLM interface that lets non-expert users query, process and visualize spatial datasets in natural language, with agent self-validation; a **dual-LLM pipeline** (a planner model hands off to a coder model) plans, generates, builds and serves multi-page React apps live from a plain-language request.

SmartShots · Tennessee Dept. of Health Dec 2023 – Dec 2024
Full-Stack Developer · Winner, IISE DAIS Student Mobile App Competition 2024

- Built the Laravel backend and Flutter app (real-time notifications, nearby vaccination-provider lookup) to improve childhood vaccination access across Tennessee; published on the App Store and Google Play and documented in *Health Informatics Journal* (2026).

Active Caregiver's Toolkit (ACTAPP) · Hillman Emergent Innovation (HEI) Jul 2024 – Present
Mobile Developer

- Built a Flutter (Dart 3, GetX) physical-activity app for rural Appalachian caregivers with an integrated FAQ chatbot that logs interaction, navigation and engagement metrics, feeding the study's behavioral-outcome analysis under IRB protocols with no PII retained.

CLIENTS & SPONSORS

ORNL · Developer · *github.com/jtupayachi/smartgiscavp · demo2.recoil.ise.utk.edu* Mar 2025 – Present

- Funding: Nuclear Safety Research and Development (NSRD).

ORNL · Developer · *github.com/jtupayachi/tof-sims-driver* Mar 2025 – Present

- Funding: Fusion Energy Sciences (FES).

RECOIL · Lead AI/Data Engineer · *m1.recoil.ise.utk.edu* Jul 2024 – Mar 2026

- Funding: U.S. Department of Energy ARPA-E, Project #DE-AR0001780.

SmartShots · Full-Stack Developer · *iise.org/Details.aspx?id=33697* Dec 2023 – Dec 2024

- *play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.ilab.smartshots*. Winner, IISE DAIS Student Mobile App Competition 2024. Funding: Tennessee Department of Health.

Active Caregiver's Toolkit · Mobile Developer Jul 2024 – Present

- *play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.ilabutk.fe_rich*. Funding: Hillman Emergent Innovation (HEI).

MENTORSHIP & LEADERSHIP

- **Mentored junior students** in model development, GitHub and GNU Parallel for faster execution; as **Lead AI/Data Engineer** of the $3M RECOIL project, led its AI/data workstream.
- **Senator**, UTK Graduate Student Senate, Industrial and Systems Engineering (2025): represented students and advocated for academic and professional development opportunities.
- **Peer reviewer** for 13 journals and conferences: PLOS ONE, Information Systems Frontiers, IISE Transactions, Optimization Letters, Software: Practice and Experience, Journal of Robotics, Journal of Sensors, IEEE IoT Magazine, J. Asian Architecture and Building Eng., IUI 2026, Winter Simulation Conference 2025, IISE Annual 2025, IEOM 2025.

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Industrial Engineering · University of Tennessee, Knoxville — May 2024 – May 2027 (expected)
Advisors: Dr. Xueping Li and Dr. Xiao-Ying Yu (ORNL)

M.S., Industrial Engineering · University of Tennessee, Knoxville — Aug 2022 – May 2024
GPA 3.93

B.S., Industrial Engineering · Pontifical Catholic University of Peru — Mar 2014 – May 2019

AWARDS & HONORS

- **IISE Future Faculty Fellow** (2025–2026), USA
- **Best Paper Award**, CIE51, 51st Conference on Computers and Industrial Engineering, Sydney, Australia (2024)
- **Winner, IISE DAIS Student Mobile App Competition**, SmartShots project, Montreal (2024)
- **HIDA Helmholtz Visiting Researcher** award, Karlsruhe Institute of Technology, Germany (2024)
- **Holiday Fellowship**, University of Tennessee, Knoxville (2022, 2023, 2024)

PUBLICATIONS 373 citations · h-index 7 · i10-index 5 (Google Scholar)

- **Tupayachi, J.**, Khan, A. N., & Li, X. (2026). Scalable decentralized prognostics for industrial systems under data heterogeneity. *Computers & Electrical Engineering, 133*, 111023.
- Khan, A. N., **Tupayachi, J.**, Dabbs, W., Chamberlin, S., Yao, B., & Li, X. (2026). CliniSense AI for automated clinical skills assessment with real-time feedback. *npj Digital Medicine*.
- Wyatt, T. H., Lowe, S., **Tupayachi, J.**, & Li, X. (2026). Design and usability testing of SmartSHOTS: A mobile app to reduce vaccine barriers for children 0–24 months. *Health Informatics Journal, 32*(1).
- Xu, H., Sun, Y., **Tupayachi, J.**, Omitaomu, O., Zlatanova, S., & Li, X. (2026). Towards autonomous freight intermodal optimization via generative AI and agentic digital twins. *Computers & Industrial Engineering*, 112464.
- Xu, H., Li, X., **Tupayachi, J.**, Lian, J. J., & Omitaomu, O. A. (2024). Automating bibliometric analysis with sentence transformers and RAG. *ACM SIGSPATIAL Urban-AI Workshop*, 1–10.
- **Tupayachi, J.**, Ferguson, M. M., & Li, X. (2024). A simulation-based real-time deep reinforcement learning approach for fighting wildfires. *ANNSIM 2024*, 1–12.
- **Tupayachi, J.**, Xu, H., Omitaomu, O. A., Camur, M. C., Sharmin, A., & Li, X. (2024). Towards next-generation urban decision support systems through AI-powered construction of scientific ontology using large language models. *Smart Cities, 7*(5), 2392–2421.
- Li, X., **Tupayachi, J.**, Sharmin, A., & Martinez Ferguson, M. (2023). Drone-aided delivery methods, challenges, and the future: A methodological review. *Drones, 7*(3), 191.
- **Tupayachi, J.**, & Silva, L. (2022). Better efficiency on non-performing loans debt recovery and portfolio valuation using machine learning techniques. *POMS Lima, Peru*.
- *Pre-prints:* arXiv:2410.18089, arXiv:2510.09048, arXiv:2511.20656, SSRN 6409258. *Talks:* IISE 2023/2024, INFORMS 2024, ACM SIGSPATIAL 2024, ANS Annual Meeting 2025.

REFERENCES

Xueping Li, Professor, UTK · xli27@utk.edu
Xiao-Ying Yu, Group Leader, ORNL · yuxiaoying@ornl.gov
Bill Hicks, Instructor, UTK · william.hicks@tennessee.edu
Carla Arbogast, Director MSIE, UTK · carboga1@utk.edu